The Box Beneath the Bench

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 2, Episode 9

Two boxes stood beneath the Mill bench. One was impressively large. The other had an ordinary-sized lid. Nib leaned toward the large box before reading either label. Lark set the invitation on the prepared ledge, where it could wait safely.

“Big box, big importance,” Nib announced confidently. “Small word, exact place,” Lark answered gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

lip

“Lowercase b begins bag,” Lark modeled clearly. “A brief voiced /b/, without an extra vowel. Look at b beside d: b has its tall stem first, with the round part on the right. Join b, i, n to read bin.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try bag, bed, big, bin, cob. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read bin and kit on these boxes,” Lark invited gently. “Which word names our letter box?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Bob hid. Sam did not.**

“Who hid?” Lark asked softly. “Which sentence gives you that information?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The correct box was the letter bin, whatever its size. Nib posted the Mill invitation there. Lark read the collection card and drew the same bin on your return-route page. The Mill reply would be left here later. Reed Hut and the Mill now had their invitations. Only Fern Lodge's envelope remained in the courier bag.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write b beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark recorded the second delivery once. Nib closed the empty Mill pocket and lifted the bag. On the next path, a shallow puddle brushed its lower strap. The last invitation was dry, but the bag needed somewhere better to rest.